

Indian Army paratroopers outside the Intercontinental Hotel, Dacca, 16 December 1971. (UPI/Bettmann via Getty Images)

H: THE KARGIL WAR, 1999

H1: Soldier, Jammu & Kashmir

Armed with the 7.62mm 1A LMG, this soldier deployed in Jammu & Kashmir is from a unit deployed to check infiltration along the Line of Control with Pakistan and also operate on the counter-insurgency grid in the region. He wears a 'Patka' helmet, the brushstroke-pattern field uniform and standard DMS boots with puttees. XV Corps (**1a**) was actively involved in counter-insurgency operations and establishment of the security grid along the Line of Control to check for infiltration.

H2: Soldier, Rashtriya Rifles, Kargil

The Kargil conflict was conducted at high altitudes, with some of the enemy posts being at 4,500m. Most of the assault operations were restricted to small infantry detachments operating with all weapons and stores being carried on a man-pack basis. Here, a soldier mans a 7.62mm FN MAG M2A1 GPMG. He wears the cold-weather parka with brushstroke-pattern trousers. One of the formations that participated in the Kargil War, 8 Mountain